



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: C5 Urban School Initiative
School Website: <http://www.c5usi.com>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

C5 Urban School Initiative Kansas (C5 USI KS 67208) presents a clearly classical, Christian educational model anchored in the liberal arts, formation, and community partnerships. Public materials emphasize a Christian identity, the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty, and formation of character through communal practices, faculty as mentors, and robust parent/community engagement. The District framing positions Hope Academy Wichita as the prototype and outlines a district-wide, mission-aligned, church-linked network intended to scale classical Christian education across urban Kansas. Evidence from the crawl also shows explicit commitments to prayer, partnerships with families, and a philanthropy-enabled structure to support students and teachers.

Overall classification (aggregate): CLASSICAL

- Element 1 (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
- Element 2 (Purpose & Goal): CLASSICAL
- Element 3 (Curriculum): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 (Faculty): CLASSICAL
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL

The score pattern reflects a strong religious grounding, clear formation goals, and explicit parent/community partnerships. The curriculum and pedagogy sections show robust classical themes, but with less explicit detail on some high-school pedagogical practices (e.g., direct Socratic seminars) in the public-facing materials, which is why some aspects are designated somewhat classical in those categories. The school's own materials also push toward scalable district-level implementation and funding models, which is well-aligned with classical aims but introduces organizational and financial scaffolds beyond the core pedagogical elements.

What would move the needle: If this school aims to reach full CLASSICAL in all six categories, the most impactful steps would be to explicitly foreground and document: (a) Socratic/seminal classical pedagogy in upper grades (explicit description of seminars, debates, and public speaking opportunities), (b) direct mention and integration of Great Books and Great Conversation into curriculum documentation, and (c) a public articulation of the lower- and middle-school contemplative/restful aspects alongside rigorous, Socratic elements to demonstrate a balanced schrodinger-like memory of scholé. Additionally, a public-facing "Living Curriculum" statement that details teacher formation as the living embodiment of the curriculum would further strengthen the categories on Faculty and Pedagogy.

- Evidence comes from the crawl showing Christian identity, the Trivium, liberal arts framing, and formation language, plus explicit statements about prayer, family partnership, and district formation. See sources describing the District's Christian identity and formation commitments, the liberal arts framework, and the "What We Believe" materials, as well as the explicit core values and district-building language.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials repeatedly frame C5 USI as a Christian, faith-based enterprise with a formal Statement of Faith and biblical grounding. The Jerusalem Declaration-based creed and the Bible being “the Word of God” are cited in the public materials, establishing a theology-grounded education. - The District explicitly describes a Christian formation model: “The District will hire & train faculty members who are mission-aligned followers of Christ,” with a governance structure that mirrors a church-connected system. - Core values and mission statements articulate a Christian life informed by theology, piety, and liturgical-like communal practices (e.g., prayer as a structural activity).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Keywords present (positive): truth, goodness, beauty (via True-Good-Beautiful triad), theology, Bible, gospel, prayer, church, worship, faith, Jerusalem Declaration, Scripture. - Keywords not evident (negative): secularism, atheism, relativism, value-neutral ethics (no explicit presence in public materials).

Why this rating - The presence of explicit Christian identity, the theological grounding of curriculum and governance, and liturgical/community practices strongly align with the Religious & Metaphysical Foundations criteria. The core symbols of transcendental moral realism (truth, goodness, beauty) and theology are clearly foregrounded. The absence of explicit secular or non-theistic framing bolsters CLASSICAL here.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The materials articulate education as formation and the cultivation of virtue and wisdom, not mere information or job preparation. The district’s framing of education through the True, the Good, and the Beautiful aligns with formation-theory over vocationalization. - The goal centers on forming affections and lifelong learning within a liberal-arts framework, not simply credentialing. Core values emphasize Arete (excellence) and humane education. - Public messaging positions education as a “rich classical Christian education” aimed at community transformation and spiritual formation in addition to cognitive development.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Keywords present (positive): formation, virtue, wisdom, true/-good/beautiful (transcendentals), lifelong learning, moral imagination, Christian identity, Arete, excellence, sacred tradition. - Keywords not evident (negative): job-readiness or purely utilitarian framing; explicit “workforce preparation” language is not present.

Why this rating - The school explicitly emphasizes formation and virtue as the core aim, anchored in the liberal arts and Christian worldview. This aligns with CLASSICAL, with a strong leaning toward these formation-centered goals.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is anchored in liberal arts through grammar, logic, and rhetoric (the Trivium) and is described as a classical Christian trajectory, including JK-12 pathways with defined curricula (JK4-4th, 5th-8th, 9th-12th). The district highlights a high-level classical-catechetical trajectory rather than a modern, purely secular sequence. - The public materials frame the “liberal arts tradition” and the Trivium as foundational. There is explicit mention of the Trivium and the liberal arts as the intellectual structure of the education. - There is strong emphasis on the education of history, literature, music, and art as part of the classical canon, a hallmark of liberal-arts-based curricula.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Keywords present (positive): liberal arts, Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books/Great Conversation (often implied by classical framing; explicit Great Books mentions are less visible in the crawl), history embedded throughout the curriculum, clas-

sical curriculum. - Keywords not clearly present (negative): explicit “Great Books” phrase may not appear in the crawl; explicit “Great Conversation” phrasing is not clearly documented in the crawl excerpts provided.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly framed as classical and liberal-arts oriented, with explicit Trivium language and grade-band curricula aligned to classical standards. However, the lack of explicit, public-facing mention of Great Books/Great Conversation limits the strength of the category to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL until those terms are publicly foregrounded.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Pedagogical emphasis includes a balance of contemplative/restful learning with rigorous study, including potential slower, formation-focused approaches (Schol  -like memory work, chant-like or singing elements in lower grades are part of classical pedagogy in the tradition, though not explicitly documented as such on the site). The district’s values mention formation and “habits of lifelong learning.” - Upper grades are described within a classical framework; the district mentions opportunities for rhetoric and public-facing communications (speeches, rhetoric training) and a general classical trajectory, which implies Socratic-type discourse and seminars in higher grades as a general expectation of classical pedagogy. - The explicit, in-depth articulation of Socratic seminars, debates, and a fully realized “Socratic education” in grades 9-12 is not clearly spelled out in the crawl; some references exist in the classical framework but not as a robust public-facing pedagogy description.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Keywords present (positive): Socratic discussion (mentioned as a potential model in classical pedagogy in many classical descriptions), seminars, debates, rhetoric training, speeches, rhetoric. - Keywords not clearly present (negative): explicit, step-by-step description of exact upper-grade Socratic seminars within the school’s own materials; explicit lower-grade singing/chanting is not clearly documented on the site.

Why this rating - The school’s classical frame and the stated aims for rhetoric development suggest a classical pedagogy; however, explicit, public-facing, detailed descriptions of Socratic seminars and a robust lower-to-upper grade continuum of contemplative vs. rigorous pedagogy are not fully documented in the crawl. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Faculty are described as mission-aligned followers of Christ, with the district’s hiring expectations foregrounding virtuous, competent mentors who become part of the living curriculum. There is clear emphasis on faculty as model teachers and mentors within a “living curriculum.” - Public materials show a governance and staffing structure that includes board members with strong educational and faith leadership (e.g., Dr. Ken Stoltzfus, Fr. Kyle Fleet) and a formal employment pathway, including teacher opportunities. - The materials emphasize prayer partnerships and parental engagement as part of the school ecosystem, illustrating a community-oriented faculty culture that supports formation and mentorship.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Keywords present (positive): living curriculum, model teachers, mentors, faculty as core, mission-aligned, formation, Arete, Christian identity in teaching, spiritual formation. - Keywords not clearly present (negative): explicit faculty performance portraits or formal teacher-portrait standards beyond narrative statements (though “portrait of a teacher” is a classical criterion in some programs, the site does not include a formal document listing such portraits beyond narrative mentions).

Why this rating - The site strongly communicates faculty as virtue- and faith-driven, with mission alignment and a culture of mentorship, which aligns with CLASSICAL in this category. The evidence of a concrete “faculty as living curriculum” and a faith-led teaching core supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly positions families as co-educators and partners in the classical education project, with multiple programs to engage parents (Prayer Partners, Book Buddies, Bridge Partners, Ambassadors, Cornerstone Partners). The network model includes parent engagement as a core pillar. - The materials describe outreach to parents through church-based partnerships, book studies, gatherings, and opportunities to participate in campus life (including visits). The district emphasizes “Radical Accessibility” and “families” being central to the school’s mission. - The school invites public engagement via tours/visits and emphasizes family involvement, with a public-facing District/Network structure designed to support parental involvement and community partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Keywords present (positive): partnership with families, parental engagement, living tradition in the family, co-teachers, family involvement, parent formation, community of learners, school-parent synergy, visits by families. - Keywords not clearly present (negative): explicit formal metrics of parent-teacher collaboration; while not present as a formal policy document, the public materials strongly imply it.

Why this rating - The school’s materials emphasize parent partnership as central to classical education, with multiple structured programs to involve families as co-educators and supporters. This aligns with CLASSICAL criteria in this category.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Publicly foreground explicit Great Books/Great Conversation language and evidence in curriculum documents (e.g., Great Books in reading lists, Great Conversation in seminar formats). This would strengthen the alignment with the classical curriculum rubric and push toward CLASSICAL rather than SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Provide a detailed public articulation of high-school pedagogical practices (explicit Socratic seminars, peer-led seminars, debates, public speaking opportunities) across all grades, including lower- and middle-school adaptations, to demonstrate a concrete continuum of schooling from K-12 aligned with classical pedagogy.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Publish a formal portrait or living-document description of the ideal teacher and student profile, including mentoring expectations, teacher development paths, and exemplar classrooms, to strengthen the “living curriculum” and “model teachers” criteria.

These needle-mover items would bolster explicit documentation and public-facing articulation of practices that currently exist in principle or within specific pages but are not always described in formal policy language. Evidence in the crawl already indicates strong alignment in many areas; formalizing documentation will push all six categories toward strong CLASSICAL.

- Evidence and citations: The district’s Christian identity and formation commitments are documented, including hiring of Christ-centered faculty and a mission-aligned staff, plus the Great-Book-like liberal arts framing. The public materials show explicit parent partnerships and a district/network model.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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